

TRAINING REPORT

Conviction

Personal workbook for Alex · recreational club golfer (hcp 14.2)

Alex

Score on Conviction: 3.8/10

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3.8 / 10 **A GROWTH AREA**

Why conviction wins holes

At 3.8, doubt is doing your thinking for you. You know the feeling: over a 150-yard approach you half-decide the 7-iron, then second-guess over the ball and steer it. Conviction is the fix that costs no swing changes — just a clearer decision. Get this to solid and you'll stripe shots you already own. This is your fastest, cheapest win right now.

WHAT YOUR SCORE MEANS

A 3.8 sits below what most 14-handicappers manage. Plenty of players your level swing with quiet belief on at least their favourite clubs. You're leaving that free confidence on the table — which is actually good news, because it's very trainable.

WHAT YOUR HANDICAP MEANS HERE

At 14.2 your misses often aren't technique — they're hesitation. The tee shot on a tight par 4, the 130-yard wedge over a bunker, the downhill 4-footer: you know the shot but doubt leaks in over the ball. That steer-and-hope swing is the typical fault here. Your quickest win is committing fully before you take the club back.

WHAT IT GAINS YOU

From shaky to solid conviction is worth real strokes — fewer steered approaches into trouble, more committed tee shots that find the short grass, cleaner short putts. Just as valuable: the calm of walking in knowing what you're doing. That quiet is where scoring lives for a 14-handicapper.

HOW TO USE IT AS A WEAPON

Turn conviction into your ally on the one shot per hole that matters most. Before that shot, say out loud in your head: 'This club, this line, full swing.' If you can't say it cleanly, step back and rebuild — don't swing on a doubt. One committed decision per hole changes your card.

Leave this and you'll keep bleeding shots to half-committed swings — the tentative wedge that comes up short, the steered drive into the trees. Not scary, just a quiet, avoidable drip of strokes and enjoyment.

HOW TO USE THIS REPORT

Treat this like grooving a swing move: one rep changes little, repetition over weeks builds automatic belief. Don't do everything — pick one or two exercises a week that appeal to you. Read the entry, try it, notice what shifts. Small, repeated reps beat one big burst. Come back to the week plan to keep the thread.

→ **Grab your phone now and block one 5-minute session this week in your calendar.**

THE ANGLES AND EXERCISES

These are options to choose from, not a checklist to complete. Pick one or two each week that appeal to you — doing everything at once backfires and drains you. Small steps you actually repeat beat a heroic week you never finish. Choose freely; that's what makes you start.

1. Commit to the shot

Conviction starts with a complete decision made behind the ball, not over it. Want it, can do it, do it — no reservation. At your level the leak is deciding the club but not fully the line, so a sliver of doubt rides along. Finishing the decision before you address the ball is your foundation.

ON THE COURSE · **Decide behind, swing over**

2 min per shot mindset · every full shot, first 3 holes

Why — Locking the decision behind the ball turns guessing into knowing — two seconds that decide whether you steer or stripe.

1) Stand behind the ball and pick club, exact target and shape. 2) Say silently: 'This club, this line.' 3) If any part feels unsure, sort it here — not over the ball. 4) Once clear, walk in, set up, and swing without re-checking. 5) No new thoughts allowed over the ball.

AT HOME · **Rehearse the decision**

5 min · 2× per week

Why — Practising a complete decision at home makes it automatic on the course, so doubt has no gap to slip into.

1) Sit quietly and picture a 140-yard approach you'll face. 2) Choose the club and one precise target out loud. 3) Say: 'I want it, I can do it, I do it.' 4) Picture the ball flying that line and landing. 5) Repeat for a tee shot and a chip.

DRILL · **Three-word commit drill**

15 min · 2× per week

Why — Repeating one commit phrase per shot grooves it until it fires automatically under pressure on the course.

On the range, before every ball say 'This club, this line' and only then start your backswing. Hit 15 balls. If you catch yourself swinging without the phrase, stop, reset, restart.

Tip — Make your club choice behind the ball final — no swapping over the ball.

Tip — If you can't picture the shot clearly, you haven't decided yet. Step back.

2. Switch off doubt

Doubt will still show up — the skill is catching it early and having a set counter-move. At 14 you often feel it as a tiny freeze over the ball or a last-second club-swap urge. The move is simple: never swing on a doubt. Step off, reset, start over. A hesitant swing costs more than an extra ten seconds.

ON THE COURSE · Step-off reset

20 sec per reset · whenever doubt appears

Why — Refusing to swing on doubt saves the wild misses that wreck a hole — one reset beats one blow-up.

- 1) The moment you feel doubt over the ball, don't swing. 2) Step fully off, both feet back behind the ball.
- 3) Take one breath. 4) Re-decide club and line clearly. 5) Re-approach and swing only when it feels clean. Give yourself full permission to reset.

AT HOME · Spot the doubt

6 min · 1× per week

Why — Naming how your doubt feels makes it easy to catch on the course before it hijacks your swing.

- 1) Recall three recent shots where you steered or came up short. 2) Write what doubt felt like — tight grip, quick glance, second-guessing the club. 3) Note when it usually appears (short shots? tight tees?). 4) Decide your counter-move: 'I step off.' 5) Read it back once.

DRILL · Reset under interruption

10 min · 1× per week

Why — Practising the reset off-course makes stepping off feel normal, not awkward, when it counts.

On the range, set up to a ball. Halfway into your address, deliberately think 'wrong club' — then step off, re-decide, re-approach, and hit. Do 10 balls. Train the reset so it's second nature.

Tip — Stepping off is strength, not weakness — the best players do it constantly.

Tip — A ten-second reset is cheaper than a penalty drop from the trees.

3. Positive and realistic

Real conviction is built on shots you genuinely own, not wishful thinking. At 14, forcing a hero shot over water with a shaky long iron isn't belief — it's hope. Building conviction on the club you actually trust — often the smart layup or your reliable 8-iron — gives you belief that holds under pressure.

ON THE COURSE · **Play the trusted shot**

1 min per decision · on risk/reward holes

Why — Choosing the shot you truly own turns conviction from a gamble into a near-certainty — and saves needless blow-ups.

1) On a tempting risky shot, ask: 'Do I own this 7 times out of 10?' 2) If no, choose the shot you do own — a layup, a shorter club, the safe side. 3) Commit fully to that shot. 4) Swing with the belief that comes from realism, not hope.

AT HOME · **Map your trusted shots**

7 min · 1× per week

Why — Knowing exactly which shots you own gives you a bank of certainty to draw conviction from on the course.

1) List clubs and shots you genuinely trust — say, 8-iron from the fairway, chip-and-run, tee shot with 3-wood. 2) Rate each honestly. 3) These are your conviction shots. 4) Plan to lean on them when pressure rises. 5) Picture pulling each off cleanly.

DRILL · **Own-it wedge ladder**

15 min · 1× per week

Why — Grooving your scoring wedges builds real, earned belief you can lean on when the card matters.

On the range, hit 5 balls each to 50, 75, 100 yards with your wedges. Track how many land in a 10-yard zone. Repeat weekly and watch the trust grow with the numbers.

Tip — Belief you can defend beats belief you have to fake.

Tip — Bank one 'that's exactly what I own' shot each round — it compounds.

4. The final look

The last second before the swing is for confirming, not reconsidering. Many 14-handicappers use that final glance at the target to start a fresh worry — 'don't hit it in the bunker' — and the swing follows the doubt. Trained right, that look says only 'yes, this' and green-lights the swing.

ON THE COURSE · Confirm, don't reconsider

2 sec per shot · a few holes per round

Why — A clean final look is the last gate that keeps doubt out of a good decision — two seconds that seal the shot.

- 1) Address the ball, decision already made.
- 2) Take one look at your target.
- 3) As you look, think only 'yes' — a confirmation, not a question.
- 4) Return your eyes to the ball and start the swing within two seconds.
- 5) No fresh thoughts in that window.

AT HOME · The two-second window

4 min · 2× per week

Why — Rehearsing a quiet final look at home makes it a habit, so you pull the trigger before doubt can speak.

- 1) Picture standing over a shot.
- 2) Rehearse: last look at target, think 'yes', eyes back to ball, swing.
- 3) Time it — aim for two seconds.
- 4) Notice the difference between confirming and questioning.
- 5) Repeat five times with different shots.

DRILL · Trigger within two seconds

12 min · 1× per week

Why — Grooving a quick trigger stops the freeze where doubt creeps in over the ball.

On the range, hit 12 balls. For each: final look, 'yes', then start the swing within two seconds — no lingering. If you stall over the ball, step off and restart. Build the rhythm.

Tip — If your final look asks a question, step off — it should only say yes.

Tip — Count 'one-two' from last look to takeaway; it kills freezing.

5. Growth mindset

Conviction that survives a bad shot is the real thing. At 14 one duffed chip can shake your belief for three holes. The shift: treat a poor shot as information — 'club was fine, I decelerated' — not as proof you can't do it. That way your conviction resets fresh on the next shot.

ON THE COURSE · Next-shot reset

15 sec per miss · every round, after misses

Why — Bouncing back with belief intact stops one mistake from becoming three ruined holes — where cards really unravel.

1) After a poor shot, give yourself one sentence of neutral info: 'I steered it, I didn't commit.' 2) No blame, no story. 3) Take a breath and walk to the ball. 4) Rebuild a full decision for the next shot. 5) Swing as if the last one never happened.

AT HOME · Turn misses into notes

6 min · after each round

Why — Reframing bad shots as data breaks the 'I can't do this' loop that quietly kills conviction.

1) After a round, list three shots that went wrong. 2) For each, write one factual cause, not a judgement. 3) Then write what you'd commit to next time. 4) Notice these are lessons, not verdicts. 5) Close the notebook and let them go.

DRILL · Bad-shot recovery reps

15 min · 1× per week

Why — Practising the reset after a miss makes bouncing back automatic when it counts on the course.

On the range, after any bad ball, immediately say one neutral fact, reset your routine fully, and hit the next with full commitment. Do this for a full basket. Train the recovery, not just the shot.

Tip — Ask 'what did that shot teach me?' not 'why am I so bad?'

Tip — One miss is an event, not a pattern — treat it that way.

INSIGHT

Here's what surprises most club players: better golfers aren't free of doubt — they're just quicker to refuse to swing on it. They step off constantly. What looks like unshakeable confidence is really a strict rule: no half-committed swings, ever. They'd rather waste ten seconds than one shot. They also decide fully behind the ball and go quiet over it. Conviction isn't a feeling they wait for — it's a decision they enforce.

FROM THE GAME

Picture the weekend medal, 16th hole, water short of the green, 150 yards. You've got 7-iron. Behind the ball you're sure. Then over it a voice says 'don't be short' — and you scoop it fat into the hazard. Now rewind: same shot, but you step off the moment that voice shows up, rebuild the decision, confirm

with one clean look, and make a committed swing. Pin-high, two putts. Same club, same swing — the only difference was refusing to swing on doubt.

OBSERVATION POINT · WATCH SOMEONE ELSE

Watching a playing partner is free learning — spot conviction in them today and you'll start catching it in yourself tomorrow.

GOOD CONVICTION SHOWS IN

Watch for a player who decides behind the ball, walks in without changing club, takes one look at the target, and swings within a couple of seconds — no fidgeting, no re-gripping.

WEAK CONVICTION SHOWS IN

Notice the player who lingers over the ball, waggles endlessly, glances at the target three or four times, or backs off then swings anyway on the same doubt.

REFLECTION & AI COACHING

Copy a prompt below into an AI assistant (ChatGPT, Claude) to think it through further yourself — a sounding board that always has time.

STARTER PROMPT — COPY & PASTE

I'm a club golfer around 14 handicap. My biggest issue is conviction: I decide on a club but doubt leaks in over the ball, so I steer approaches and come up short — like a 140-yard shot over a bunker where I get tentative and duff it. I want committed swings. What's one practical thing I can start doing to commit fully before the swing?

DIG DEEPER — 1

I mostly lose conviction on short wedge shots inside 100 yards and tight tee shots. Why might doubt hit hardest exactly there, and how do I counter it?

DIG DEEPER — 2

When I hit a bad shot, my belief stays shaken for a few holes. How can I reset my conviction quickly so one miss doesn't become three?

YOUR PLAN FOR THE COMING WEEKS

A realistic four-week build — a couple of short sessions a week, nothing overwhelming.

Week 1**COMMIT BEHIND THE BALL** · ±20 min/week

Try 'Decide behind, swing over' on the first three holes of a round, plus 'Rehearse the decision' at home once.

Week 2**REFUSE TO SWING ON DOUBT** · ±20 min/week

Use the step-off reset whenever doubt appears; do 'Spot the doubt' at home once.

Week 3**BUILD REALISTIC BELIEF** · ±25 min/week

Map your trusted shots at home; on the course play the shot you own on risk holes. Add the final-look confirm.

Week 4**BOUNCE BACK, APPLY IT ALL** · ±25 min/week

Use next-shot reset after every miss; combine commit, reset and final look across a full round on your own.

ON THE COURSE — BEFORE, DURING, AFTER**BEFORE THE ROUND**

- Decide your first tee shot fully behind the ball, no swapping.
- Name your three most trusted shots for today.
- Remind yourself: no swing on a doubt — I step off.

DURING

- Say 'this club, this line' before every full shot.
- Step off and rebuild the moment doubt shows up.
- Take one final look, think 'yes', then swing.

AFTER THE ROUND

- Note one shot where full commitment paid off.
- Turn each bad shot into one factual lesson.
- Score yourself: how many resets did you allow?

→ Next round, say 'this club, this line' before every full shot on the front nine.

QUESTIONS TO ASK YOURSELF

Where today did doubt creep in over the ball, and did I step off?

Which committed swing felt the best, and what made it feel sure?

After a miss, how quickly did my belief come back?

HOW YOU KNOW IT'S WORKING

- ☐ Stepped off and reset at least twice in a round.
- ☐ Said the commit phrase before every full shot for nine holes.
- ☐ Recovered belief within one shot after a miss.
- ☐ Chose a trusted shot over a hero shot three times.

→ Pick just one exercise this week and try it on the first three holes — that's all.

Want it, can do it, do it.

YOUR MANTRA

YOUR COURSE CUE

Decide behind, look once, swing on yes.